

[Company name]

[Document title]

[Document subtitle]

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1. Technical Proposal Blueprint: Full

> **Version:** BM-TS-01-v2.0 (TITAN)

> **Last updated:** 2026-03-19

2. Blueprint Rules: MANDATORY COMPLIANCE

> **This skeleton MUST be followed exactly.** No section may be skipped, reordered, merged, or shortened below its stated word-count floor. Deviation requires explicit written approval from Gyan (URGPRND7Z) before proceeding.

2.1 Structural Compliance

- Follow every section in the order listed, no reordering
- Every section with a word target MUST hit its stated floor (minimum word count)
- Every `[VARIABLE: ...]` placeholder MUST be resolved before the draft is considered complete
- Every `[REUSABLE BLOCK: slug]` tag MUST be expanded from the referenced reusable file
- Every visual spec MUST produce an actual diagram, table, or matrix, not a placeholder description

2.2 Consistency Anchors

- Heading hierarchy: H1 = document title, H2 = major section, H3 = subsection, H4 = sub-subsection
- No manual numbering in headings, the DOCX template handles numbering
- Table structure: always include a header row; no merged cells; keep columns consistent throughout
- Confidence tags: ● Native | ● Partial | Gap | N/A, apply at section level AND at claim level
- Voice: third person ("SettleMint provides", "DALP enables"), never first person
- Tense: present tense for capabilities, future tense for delivery phases

2.3 Pre-Write Checklist (complete before drafting any section)

- ☐ `feedback/lessons.md` read and internalized
- ☐ `setup/core-positioning.md` read
- ☐ `setup/writing-style.md` read
- ☐ `setup/ip-protection.md` read
- ☐ `setup/mermaid-diagram-standards.md` read
- ☐ All source files in "Global Source Priority" confirmed accessible
- ☐ All `[VARIABLE: ...]` placeholders identified and sourced from RFP/brief

2.4 Output Quality Gates (validate before delivery)

- ☐ Cover page: all placeholders resolved, no placeholder text remaining
- ☐ TOC: auto-generated, not hand-typed
- ☐ Word count: total output within target range ($\pm 10\%$; below floor = failure)
- ☐ Screenshot minimum: include at least 12 DALP screenshots sourced from `../shared/brand/dalp-screenshots/` or the catalog/registry references below



- [] Screenshot distribution: spread screenshots across at least 4 major sections; do not dump them into one section or appendix
- [] Screenshot variety: cover at least 4 screenshot categories unless the bid is narrowly focused on one asset class
- [] Screenshot captions: every screenshot is followed immediately by a ``Figure X: ...`` caption explaining what the screenshot proves
- [] Visual count: include diagrams, tables, and screenshots wherever they reinforce the narrative or help the evaluator understand faster than prose alone. There is no upper limit; use as many as the section content warrants
- [] Confidence tags: present on every substantive DALP capability claim
- [] No unsupported claims: every capability assertion maps to a source file
- [] No roadmap language: "coming soon", "planned", "will support" prohibited unless marked [ROADMAP]
- [] Prose quality: no section >50% bullets, rewrite to prose if needed
- [] Final sweep: run 7-sweep copy-editing framework (clarity, voice, structure, persuasion, specificity, rhythm, polish)
- [] No emoji in output: all emoji characters (confidence dots, status indicators, any Unicode emoji) stripped and replaced with text equivalents before delivery
- [] Mermaid diagram count: minimum 30 mermaid code blocks in the markdown output (see mandatory diagrams rule below)
- [] Validation script: run ``scripts/validate_proposal.py output.md full`` and confirm PASS before DOCX conversion

2.5 MANDATORY DIAGRAMS (Gyan directive, 2026-04-03)

Every technical proposal MUST include mermaid diagram code blocks in the markdown output.

Minimum count for full variant: 15 mermaid blocks.

See ``setup/diagram-manifest.md`` for the required diagram list per section.

A proposal without mermaid blocks in the markdown is INCOMPLETE and must not proceed to DOCX conversion.

The DOCX conversion script (``scripts/markdown2docx.py``) renders mermaid to PNG automatically.

Do NOT replace mermaid blocks with text placeholders or descriptions of what a diagram would show.

Do NOT skip diagrams to save tokens or reduce output length.

Mandatory validation: Run ``scripts/validate_proposal.py <output.md> full`` before DOCX conversion.

If the script returns FAIL, revise the markdown to add missing diagrams before proceeding.

2.6 Original Skeleton-Specific Rules

- Purpose: proposal-writing blueprint only
- Output type: structural instructions only
- Prohibited: finished narrative, persuasive prose, claims without source support, client-specific facts without evidence, duplicated content across sections without purpose

- Heading rule: no manual numbering in headings
- Placeholder rule: replace all client- or bid-specific items with `[VARIABLE: ...]`
- Evidence rule: every substantive claim must map to one or more listed source files
- Tone rule: institutional, precise, evidence-led, calm, confident, non-promotional
- Writer stance: describe platform capabilities and delivery approach; do not speculate; do not imply custom development beyond platform configuration/integration
- DALP naming rule: use **DALP** only; if legacy source says ATK, update terminology

3. Global Writer Guidance

3.1 Proposal Objective

- Demonstrate fit for `[VARIABLE: buyer / authority / programme]`
- Show controlled understanding of `[VARIABLE: asset class / market structure / deployment scope / regulatory perimeter]`
- Prove production readiness across architecture, security, operations, implementation, and support
- Reduce perceived implementation risk through structure, evidence, references, and explicit control model

3.2 Global Source Priority

- (i) `templates/technical-proposal-part1.md`
- (ii) `templates/technical-proposal-part2.md`
- (iii) `reusable/about-settlemint.md`
- (iv) `reusable/about-dalp.md`
- (v) `reusable/reference-projects.md`
- (vi) `reusable/implementation-plan.md`
- (vii) `reusable/deployment-options.md`
- (viii) `reusable/support-sla.md`
- (ix) `content/01-company-profile/main.md`
- (x) `content/02-architecture/main.md`
- (xi) `content/03-asset-lifecycle/main.md`
- (xii) `content/03-integrations/main.md`
- (xiii) `content/04-deployment/main.md`
- (xiv) `content/05-security/main.md`
- (xv) `content/06-implementation/main.md`
- (xvi) `content/06-technical-proposal/main.md`
- (xvii) `content/07-references/main.md`
- (xviii) `content/07-support-sla/main.md`

3.3 Global Visual System

- Use clean enterprise diagrams, matrices, timelines, and comparison tables
- Include diagrams, tables, and screenshots wherever they reinforce the narrative or help the evaluator understand faster than prose alone. There is no upper limit; use as many as the section content warrants
- Every visual needs:

- title
- purpose
- source basis
- preferred format
- suggested placement
- note on what not to overcomplicate
- No decorative visuals
- Include DALP platform screenshots wherever they reinforce the narrative. Select from the screenshot catalog (`shared/brand/dalp-screenshots/CATALOG.md`) and the screenshot registry (`setup/screenshot-registry.md`). Choose screenshots that show exactly what the section discusses
- Prefer editable shapes/tables over pasted images where possible in Word, but use screenshots when they communicate faster than prose

3.4 Visual Element Policy

> **Directive (Gyan, 2026-04-05):** Screenshots are mandatory proof assets in every proposal skeleton. They are not optional decoration.

- **Minimum DALP screenshots for this variant:** 12
- **Section spread minimum:** use screenshots in at least 4 distinct major sections
- **Category variety minimum:** use screenshots from at least 4 screenshot categories unless the request is deliberately limited to one asset class or one workflow
- **Proof plan before prose:** before drafting, assign each planned screenshot to the section where the capability is first introduced
- **Inline placement only:** place each screenshot immediately after the paragraph it proves. Never batch screenshots at the end of a section or in a screenshot gallery
- **Caption rule:** every screenshot must be followed on the next line by a `Figure X: ...` caption that states what the evaluator is seeing and why it matters
- **Use the catalog and registry:** select screenshots from `../shared/brand/dalp-screenshots/CATALOG.md` and `setup/screenshot-registry.md`
- **Distribute proof:** after one section receives two screenshots, the next screenshot should usually land in another relevant section unless the section is an asset-class deep dive that genuinely needs more proof
- **No upper limit:** there is no cap on diagrams, tables, or screenshots when they materially improve evaluator understanding
- **Validation:** `scripts/validate\_proposal.py` checks screenshot count, caption coverage, section distribution, and screenshot-category variety

3.4.1 Section-to-Screenshot Map

Section Topic	Primary Screenshot Files From Catalog	Use In These Sections	Placement Rule
Executive Summary /	`02 - Dashboard/Dashboard 1.png`; `02 - Dashboard/Dashboard - Map and Statistics.png`	Executive summary, opening platform	Use one overview screenshot only, directly after the paragraph that

Opportunity Framing		proof, operating-model context	introduces the platform and buyer context
Platform Overview / About DALP	`04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer.png`; `21 - Insights/Insights - Asset Overview.png`	Platform overview, DALP breadth, lifecycle coverage	Pair with platform description, not in a later gallery
Asset Creation / Issuance	`04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer.png`; `04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer - Step 4 - Instrument Details.png`; `04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer Review and Deploy 1.png`	Issuance workflow, product configuration, deployment controls	Place next to the first asset-creation explanation
Compliance / Policy Controls	`04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer - Step 6 - Compliance Modules.png`; `14 - Compliance and Policy Templates/Compliance Policy Templates.png`; `14 - Compliance and Policy Templates/Policy Template - Expression Builder.png`	Compliance, transfer rules, regulatory controls, policy governance	Use in the compliance section itself, not in a generic appendix
Identity / Eligibility / KYC	`15 - Identity and Verification/Onchain Identity.png`; `15 - Identity and Verification/Verification Topics.png`; `04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer Compliance Identity.png`	Identity, eligibility, investor verification, trusted issuer workflows	Keep beside the identity discussion and caption the control being evidenced
Permissions / Governance / Access Control	`04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer - Step 7 - Asset Permissions Config.png`; `04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer Permissions.png`; `19 - Settings and Admin/Activity Log.png`	Governance, RBAC, segregation of duties, auditability	Use where governance or access control is described
Settlement / DvP / XvP	`16 - XVP Settlement/XVP Setup 1.png`; `16 - XVP Settlement/XVP Details 1.png`; `16 - XVP Settlement/XvP API Light.png`	Settlement, post-trade workflow, atomic exchange, integration-backed	Place inside the settlement section, not clustered with monitoring

		settlement	
Operations / Monitoring / Support	`20 - Monitoring/Blockchain Monitoring.png`; `20 - Monitoring/API Monitoring - Overview.png`; `19 - Settings and Admin/Activity.png`	Operations, observability, SLA proof, production supervision	Use in the operations, deployment, or support section that cites runtime control
Asset-Class Proof	Bonds: `06 - Bonds/Bonds Detail 2.png`; Equity: `07 - Equity/Equity Detail 1.png`; Funds: `08 - Funds/Fund Detail 1.png`; Deposits: `09 - Deposits/Deposits Listing.png`; Stablecoins: `10 - Stablecoins/Stablecoin Detail 1.png`; Precious Metals: `11 - Precious Metal 1.png`; Real Estate: `12 - Real Estate/Real Estate - Doha Business Towers - Asset Details.png`	Asset-class-specific sections, solution fit, use-case proof	Prefer the asset class requested by the buyer before reusing generic dashboard screenshots
Integration / API / Extensibility	`19 - Settings and Admin/API Keys.png`; `16 - XVP Settlement/XvP API Light.png`; `19 - Settings and Admin/Addons.png`	API, integration, extensibility, workflow automation	Use only where APIs or extensibility are discussed
Branding / White-Label	`19 - Settings and Admin/Theme 1.png`; `19 - Settings and Admin/Theme 2.png`	White-label, branding, tenant experience	Keep in branding sections only, not as generic filler

4. Cover Page and Front Matter

Consistency anchor: All placeholders resolved. No body prose beyond labels. Template styling only.

4.1 Cover Page

- Word target: 0-50
- Include placeholders only:
 - `[VARIABLE: proposal title]`
 - `[VARIABLE: client name]`
 - `[VARIABLE: submission date]`
 - `[VARIABLE: version]`
 - `[VARIABLE: confidentiality level]`
 - `[VARIABLE: primary contact]`
- Source references:
 - `templates/technical-proposal-part1.md`
- Writer instructions:
 - keep minimal
 - no body prose beyond placeholders/labels
- Visual spec:
 - none beyond template styling

4.2 Table of Contents

- Word target: 0
- Writer instructions:
 - auto-generated only
 - do not hand-edit

> **Section complete when:** All placeholders present and clearly labeled. No body prose.

5. Executive Summary

- Word target: 1800-2400
- Purpose:
 - summarize buyer context, problem framing, proposed response, differentiators, delivery confidence
- Source references:
 - `templates/technical-proposal-part1.md`
 - `reusable/about-settlemint.md`
 - `reusable/about-dalp.md`
 - relevant references from `reusable/reference-projects.md`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Always opens with the client's stated challenge before introducing the solution. No bullet lists, prose only.

5.1 Executive Summary > Context and Strategic Drivers

- Word target: 250-350
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Screenshot: Dashboard overview screenshots showing DALP operational context for the client's domain
- Include:
 - `[VARIABLE: client mandate]`
 - `[VARIABLE: programme objectives]`
 - `[VARIABLE: regulatory / operational / market drivers]`
- Writer instructions:
 - tailor tightly to bid language
 - use buyer terminology where known
 - do not copy requirement text verbatim

5.2 Executive Summary > Why This Programme Is Hard

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Challenge summary matrix (challenge, complexity, implication)
- Word target: 200-300
- Include instruction themes:
 - lifecycle complexity
 - governance and compliance burden
 - operationalization gap between pilot and production

- integration burden across custody, payments, identity, reporting
- Writer instructions:
 - frame the challenge without fearmongering
 - set up DALP as control plane, not as abstract tech stack

5.3 Executive Summary > Proposed Response

- Word target: 450-600
- Include:
 - `[VARIABLE: deployment model]`
 - `[VARIABLE: target asset scope]`
 - `[VARIABLE: compliance approach]`
 - `[VARIABLE: custody model]`
 - `[VARIABLE: integration perimeter]`
 - `[VARIABLE: phased delivery summary]`
- Key messages:
 - unified lifecycle coverage
 - ex-ante compliance
 - deployment flexibility
 - integration with existing institutional stack
- Visual spec:
 - one 5-box solution summary graphic
 - format: horizontal operating model diagram

5.4 Executive Summary > Why SettleMint

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Key credentials and proof-points summary
- Word target: 350-500
- Pull from sources only:
 - market tenure
 - production record
 - regulated delivery experience
 - sovereign / bank / market infrastructure relevance
- Writer instructions:
 - do not overstuff with all credentials here; reserve detail for company section

5.5 Executive Summary > Why DALP

- Word target: 350-500
- Focus:
 - platform breadth
 - lifecycle model
 - control plane positioning
 - interoperability and operations
- Visual spec:
 - one lifecycle wheel or layered stack
 - source basis: `reusable/about-dalp.md`

5.6 Executive Summary > Reference Fit Snapshot

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Reference summary (name, geography, asset class, relevance)
- Word target: 150-250
- Include:
 - 3 most relevant reference names as placeholders or selected projects
 - one-line relevance note for each
- Writer instructions:
 - map by geography, asset class, or operating model

5.7 Executive Summary > Tone and Avoidance

- Tone guidance:
 - specific
 - executive-technical
 - confident
 - low-hype
- Avoid:
 - full technical deep dive
 - detailed implementation tables
 - repeated feature catalogues

> **Section complete when:** Client name and programme name appear in opening paragraph. At least two named differentiators present. Reference snapshot included. No bullet lists, prose only throughout.

6. About SettleMint

- Word target: 2200-2800
- Source references:
 - `reusable/about-settlemint.md`
 - `content/01-company-profile/main.md`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Company facts table present in every variant. No claims beyond approved source material.

6.1 About SettleMint > Company Overview

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Company facts and positioning summary
- Word target: 250-350
- Cover:
 - positioning
 - mission
 - target institutional segments

6.2 About SettleMint > History and Market Position

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Evolution timeline (era, focus, outcome)
- Word target: 300-400
- Cover:
 - evolution narrative
 - production maturity
 - institutional focus

6.3 About SettleMint > Production Credentials

- Word target: 350-450
- Include proof-point table
- Visual spec:
 - credential summary table
 - 2-column format

6.4 About SettleMint > Regulatory Readiness

> MANDATORY DIAGRAM: Regulatory Compliance Framework (block/matrix: jurisdiction mapping, regulatory templates). Include as ``mermaid code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Jurisdiction-to-framework mapping
 - Screenshot: Compliance Policy Templates showing regulatory configuration capabilities
- Word target: 250-350
- Include jurisdiction/framework table
- Writer instructions:
 - present supported regulatory alignment carefully
 - avoid implying legal advice

6.5 About SettleMint > Team and Delivery Capability

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Team composition and domain expertise summary
- Word target: 250-350
- Focus:
 - engineering depth
 - financial domain depth
 - enterprise delivery discipline

6.6 About SettleMint > Ecosystem and Partnerships

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Partner ecosystem categories
- Word target: 200-300
- Focus:
 - custody

- infrastructure
- SI / partner ecosystem

6.7 About SettleMint > Why Relevant to This Bid

- Word target: 250-350
- Include placeholders:
 - `[VARIABLE: buyer type]`
 - `[VARIABLE: geography]`
 - `[VARIABLE: programme risk profile]`
- Writer instructions:
 - connect credentials to evaluator concerns

6.8 About SettleMint > Visuals

- Visual 1: company proof-points table
- Visual 2: geographic / sector footprint matrix
- Visual 3: three-pillar credibility diagram

6.9 About SettleMint > Avoid

- avoid founder-story prose
- avoid investor detail unless procurement cares
- avoid unverified numbers beyond source docs

> **Section complete when:** Company facts table present with 6+ approved metrics. Regulatory readiness table included. No unapproved claims.

7. About DALP

- Word target: 3000-3800
- Source references:
 - `reusable/about-dalp.md`
 - `templates/technical-proposal-part1.md`
 - `content/02-architecture/main.md`
 - `content/03-asset-lifecycle/main.md`
 - `content/03-integrations/main.md`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Lifecycle pillar count (5) and names (Create, Comply, Custody, Settle, Service) consistent across all proposals.

7.1 About DALP > Platform Overview

> **MANDATORY DIAGRAM:** Platform Architecture Overview (4-layer block diagram). Include as ``mermaid code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `platform-architecture-layers.mmd` for layered platform view
 - Screenshot: Dashboard showing DALP platform overview
 - Screenshot: Asset Designer showing configuration interface

- Word target: 300-400
- Position DALP as lifecycle platform and control plane

7.2 About DALP > Core Lifecycle Pillars

> MANDATORY DIAGRAM: Asset Lifecycle State Machine (state diagram: issuance, active, paused, frozen, redeemed). Include as `mermaid` code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `token-lifecycle-states.mmd` for lifecycle state flow
 - Screenshot: Asset Operations screenshots showing lifecycle management
 - Screenshot: Bonds detail screenshots for bond servicing examples
 - Table: Lifecycle pillars summary with capabilities per pillar
- Word target: 900-1200 total
- Use one subsection per pillar:
 - Issuance
 - Compliance
 - Custody
 - Settlement
 - Servicing
- Writer instructions:
 - 150-220 words per pillar
 - structure each as capability + operational outcome + evidence anchor
- Visual spec:
 - lifecycle architecture graphic

7.3 About DALP > Platform Foundations

> MANDATORY DIAGRAM: Integration Architecture (block/flow diagram: DALP to core banking, custody, KYC, payments). Include as `mermaid` code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `identity-access-model.mmd` for IAM model
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `integration-architecture.mmd` for interoperability view
 - Screenshot: Identity & Verification screenshots for identity/access
 - Screenshot: Monitoring screenshots for observability/operations
- Word target: 600-800
- Subsections:
 - Identity and Access
 - Integration and Interoperability
 - Observability and Operations

7.4 About DALP > Supported Asset Classes and Operating Scope

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Asset class comparison matrix
 - Screenshot: Asset-specific screenshots from Bonds, Equity, Funds, Deposits, Stablecoins, Precious Metals, or Real Estate categories
- Word target: 300-450

- Include asset-class table
- Include placeholders if bid requires prioritization:
 - `[VARIABLE: in-scope assets]`
 - `[VARIABLE: phase-2 assets]`

7.5 About DALP > Standards and Protocols

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Standards/protocol support matrix (standard, version, DALP coverage)
- Word target: 250-350
- Use standards matrix

7.6 About DALP > Key Differentiators

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Differentiator comparison (DALP vs generic alternatives)
- Word target: 350-500
- Compare DALP approach against generic alternatives only
- Avoid naming competitors unless required by bid

7.7 About DALP > Relevance to Client Scope

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: DALP strength-to-bid-priority mapping
- Word target: 300-400
- Map DALP strengths to `[VARIABLE: bid priorities]`

7.8 About DALP > Visuals

- Visual 1: lifecycle pillar diagram
- Visual 2: standards/support matrix
- Visual 3: differentiator comparison table

7.9 About DALP > Avoid

- avoid dumping every feature from source docs
- avoid developer-level jargon without operational translation
- avoid repeating company profile content

> **Section complete when:** All five lifecycle pillars named and described. Asset class table or diagram present. Differentiator comparison included.

8. Customer References

- Word target: 2200-3000
- Source references:
 - `reusable/reference-projects.md`
 - `content/07-references/main.md`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Summary table uses identical column structure across all proposals. Only approved reference names used.

8.1 Customer References > Summary Table

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Reference summary (client, use case, relevance, geography, asset theme)
- Word target: 150-250
- Mandatory instruction:
 - include all available named references in one summary table
 - columns: client / use case / relevance / geography / asset theme

8.2 Customer References > Relevance Selection Logic

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Selection criteria mapping
- Word target: 100-150
- Include placeholder:
 - `[VARIABLE: why these examples were selected]`

8.3 Customer References > Expanded Reference 1

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Reference detail (context, challenge, solution pattern, outcome)
- Word target: 400-550
- Structure:
 - context
 - challenge
 - solution pattern
 - outcome / relevance
 - transferability to this bid

8.4 Customer References > Expanded Reference 2

- Word target: 400-550
- Same structure

8.5 Customer References > Expanded Reference 3

- Word target: 400-550
- Same structure

8.6 Customer References > Reference Fit Matrix

- Word target: 250-350
- Table fields:
 - reference
 - buyer requirement area
 - why relevant
 - what evidence it supports
- Visual spec:

- one matrix only; no case-study infographics unless client requests

8.7 Customer References > Avoid

- avoid inventing outcomes not in source files
- avoid too many expanded case studies unless highly relevant
- avoid vague “similar to your needs” claims without explicit link

> **Section complete when:** Summary table includes all approved references. Expanded references follow context/challenge/solution/outcome structure. Selection rationale stated.

9. Understanding of Requirements

- Word target: 2200-3000
- Source references:
 - `templates/technical-proposal-part1.md`
 - RFP / bid documents `[VARIABLE: source path]`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Requirement domains map to the same category labels used in the compliance matrix.

9.1 Understanding of Requirements > Client Context

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Client context summary (mandate, drivers, stakeholders)
- Word target: 250-350
- Use bid-specific placeholders:
 - `[VARIABLE: institution mandate]`
 - `[VARIABLE: transformation drivers]`
 - `[VARIABLE: target users / participants]`

9.2 Understanding of Requirements > Requirement Domains

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Requirement-domain mapping matrix
- Word target: 700-900
- Use domain mapping table
- Mandatory domains:
 - Product / Asset Scope
 - Identity / Onboarding
 - Compliance / Control
 - Settlement / Cash Leg
 - Integration / Reporting
 - Infrastructure / Operations

9.3 Understanding of Requirements > Key Challenges Identified

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Challenge blocks (buyer need, complexity, implication)

- Word target: 500-700
- Use 4-6 challenge blocks
- Each block structure:
 - buyer need
 - implied complexity
 - why it matters

9.4 Understanding of Requirements > Requirement Prioritization

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: MoSCoW or priority matrix
- Word target: 250-350
- Use MoSCoW or equivalent matrix if helpful
- Include placeholders for mandatory vs optional evaluation criteria

9.5 Understanding of Requirements > Response Principles

- Word target: 250-350
- Use 4-6 principles such as:
 - control before speed
 - reuse before fragmentation
 - phased delivery
 - evidence-led compliance

9.6 Understanding of Requirements > Visuals

- Visual 1: requirement-domain matrix
- Visual 2: challenge-to-solution bridge graphic

9.7 Understanding of Requirements > Avoid

- avoid repeating full RFP wording
- avoid solution detail too early
- avoid unstructured laundry lists

> **Section complete when:** Requirement domains mapped to table. Key challenges identified with implied complexity. Response principles stated.

10. Proposed Solution and Functional Capabilities

- Word target: 4200-5200
- Source references:
 - `templates/technical-proposal-part1.md`
 - `reusable/about-dalp.md`
 - `content/03-asset-lifecycle/main.md`
 - `content/03-integrations/main.md`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Every capability claim carries a confidence tag (●/●/●). Solution boundary stated before detail.

10.1 Proposed Solution and Functional Capabilities > Solution Overview

- Word target: 300-450
- Include:
 - solution boundary
 - platform components in scope
 - actors / participants
 - `[VARIABLE: deployment assumption]`
- Visual spec:
 - end-to-end solution context diagram

10.2 Proposed Solution and Functional Capabilities > Issuance and Asset Configuration

> MANDATORY DIAGRAM: Composable Token Architecture (3-layer: DALPAsset + Features + Compliance). Include as `mermaid` code block.

> MANDATORY DIAGRAM: Token Feature Execution Pipeline (hooks, rewrite, execute, post-hooks). Include as `mermaid` code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `data-flow-asset-creation.mmd` for asset creation flow
 - Screenshot: Asset Designer wizard steps showing configuration interface
 - Table: Asset configuration options
- Word target: 500-650
- Cover:
 - asset setup
 - lifecycle logic
 - factory/configuration model
 - governance before activation

10.3 Proposed Solution and Functional Capabilities > Identity and Eligibility

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `identity-access-model.mmd` for identity model
 - Screenshot: Identity & Verification screenshots showing onboarding workflow
 - Table: Role/claims matrix
- Word target: 450-600
- Cover:
 - OnchainID role
 - claims model
 - issuer trust model
 - onboarding workflow

10.4 Proposed Solution and Functional Capabilities > Compliance Enforcement

> MANDATORY DIAGRAM: Compliance Evaluation Flow (flowchart: transfer request, module checks, pass/fail). Include as `mermaid` code block.

- Word target: 600-750
- Cover:
 - ex-ante checks
 - module composition
 - transfer controls
 - auditability
- Visual spec:
 - transaction compliance flow

10.5 Proposed Solution and Functional Capabilities > Transfer, Settlement, and Cash-Leg Coordination

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Screenshot: XVP Settlement screenshots showing settlement interface
 - Table: Settlement model comparison (DvP, XvP, HTLC)
- Word target: 500-650
- Cover:
 - transfer path
 - DvP/XvP model
 - failure behavior
 - determinism

10.6 Proposed Solution and Functional Capabilities > Lifecycle Servicing and Corporate Actions

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `token-lifecycle-states.mmd` for lifecycle state transitions
 - Screenshot: Asset Operations, Bonds detail screenshots showing servicing interface
 - Table: Lifecycle event types
- Word target: 450-600
- Cover:
 - coupon/dividend/yield
 - maturity/redemption
 - governance events
 - operational servicing

10.7 Proposed Solution and Functional Capabilities > Integration and Interoperability

> MANDATORY DIAGRAM: Integration Architecture (block/flow: APIs, core banking, custody, payments, feeds). Include as ``mermaid code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `integration-architecture.mmd` for integration topology
 - Table: Integration matrix (system, protocol, direction, status)
- Word target: 550-700
- Cover:
 - API / SDK / CLI

- core-system integration
- custody and payments
- feeds / reporting / events

10.8 Proposed Solution and Functional Capabilities > Functional Fit Matrix

- Word target: 300-450
- Table with columns:
 - functional requirement
 - DALP capability
 - source reference
 - response status
 - notes / assumptions

10.9 Proposed Solution and Functional Capabilities > Avoid

- avoid repeating architecture internals in full
- avoid turning section into pure feature brochure

> **Section complete when:** Solution boundary diagram present. Every functional area has a confidence-tagged response. Fit matrix complete.

11. Technical Architecture

- Word target: 3000-3800
- Source references:
 - `templates/technical-proposal-part1.md`
 - `content/02-architecture/main.md`
 - `content/04-deployment/main.md`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Four-layer naming convention consistent across all architecture sections and diagrams.

11.1 Technical Architecture > Architectural Principles

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Architecture principles summary
- Word target: 250-350
- Use principle list:
 - lifecycle-first
 - durable execution
 - defense-in-depth
 - separation of concerns
 - provider abstraction

11.2 Technical Architecture > Layered Architecture

> **MANDATORY DIAGRAM:** 4-Layer Architecture diagram (on-chain, execution, API, presentation). Include as `mermaid` code block.

- Word target: 700-900
- Subsections:
 - On-chain layer
 - Execution/orchestration layer
 - API/integration layer
 - Presentation/operations layer
- Visual spec:
 - 4-layer architecture diagram

11.3 Technical Architecture > Data Architecture

> MANDATORY DIAGRAM: Data Flow / Privacy Architecture (flowchart: chain state, app state, indexed, audit). Include as `mermaid` code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `data-flow-asset-creation.mmd` for data flow patterns
 - Table: Data layer inventory (chain state, app state, indexed, audit)
- Word target: 450-600
- Cover:
 - chain state
 - application state
 - indexed / analytical state
 - audit evidence model

11.4 Technical Architecture > Network and Chain Topology

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Network type comparison (public, private, multi-chain)
- Word target: 350-500
- Cover:
 - supported EVM options
 - private/public decision framing
 - multi-chain note if relevant
- Placeholder:
 - `[VARIABLE: preferred chain model]`

11.5 Technical Architecture > Multi-Tenancy and Environment Segregation

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Environment segregation model
- Word target: 300-450
- Cover:
 - tenant isolation
 - environment separation
 - governance boundaries

11.6 Technical Architecture > Operational Architecture

> MANDATORY DIAGRAM: Observability Stack (block/layered: metrics, logs, traces, dashboards, alerting). Include as `mermaid` code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Screenshot: Monitoring screenshots showing operational dashboards
 - Table: Workflow durability and execution model
- Word target: 350-450
- Cover:
 - execution reliability
 - workflow durability
 - transaction lifecycle
 - indexer/read-model behavior

11.7 Technical Architecture > Visuals

- Visual 1: 4-layer stack
- Visual 2: environment topology
- Visual 3: transaction lifecycle/state flow
- Visual 4: data architecture / evidence path

11.8 Technical Architecture > Avoid

- avoid excessive code-level detail
- avoid vendor-deep cloud implementation unless asked

> **Section complete when:** Layered architecture diagram present. All four layers described. Data architecture and environment topology covered.

12. Security

- Word target: 2600-3400
- Source references:
 - `templates/technical-proposal-part2.md`
 - `content/05-security/main.md`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Security control descriptions match approved source wording. Certification claims cite exact scope.

12.1 Security > Security Model Overview

> **MANDATORY DIAGRAM:** Security Architecture (layered defense-in-depth diagram). Include as ```mermaid code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `security-layers.mmd` for defense-in-depth model
- Word target: 250-350
- Cover:
 - security posture
 - three-domain trust model
 - defense-in-depth

12.2 Security > Authentication and Access Control

> MANDATORY DIAGRAM: RBAC / Access Control Model (flowchart: roles, permissions, verification gates). Include as ```mermaid code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `identity-access-model.mmd` for access control model
 - Table: Authentication method comparison (session, API key, CLI)
- Word target: 500-650
- Cover:
 - session vs API auth boundary
 - RBAC
 - verification gates
 - separation of duties

12.3 Security > Key Management and Custody Integration

> MANDATORY DIAGRAM: Custody and Key Management Flow (flowchart: Key Guardian tiers, signing, maker-checker). Include as ```mermaid code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Key storage backend comparison (tiers, providers, use cases)
- Word target: 450-600
- Cover:
 - Key Guardian tiers
 - DFNS / Fireblocks patterns
 - maker-checker
 - HSM / secret manager options

12.4 Security > Data Protection and Encryption

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Data protection controls (at rest, in transit, field-level)
- Word target: 350-500
- Cover:
 - at rest
 - in transit
 - field-level secrets handling

12.5 Security > Compliance Controls and Auditability

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Audit evidence model and SIEM compatibility
- Word target: 350-500
- Cover:
 - immutable evidence
 - event logs
 - SIEM compatibility
 - reporting implications

12.6 Security > Testing and Assurance

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Testing/assurance approach summary
- Word target: 250-350
- Cover:
 - penetration testing
 - remediation approach
 - evidence sharing model

12.7 Security > Security Responsibility Matrix

- Word target: 200-300
- Table columns:
 - control area
 - SettleMint responsibility
 - client responsibility
 - shared notes

12.8 Security > Visuals

- Visual 1: security-domain diagram
- Visual 2: layered control model
- Visual 3: responsibility matrix

12.9 Security > Avoid

- avoid unsupported certification claims
- avoid generic cyber boilerplate disconnected from DALP

> **Section complete when:** Security domain diagram or responsibility matrix present. Authentication, key management, and data protection all addressed. No unsupported certification claims.

13. Project Implementation & Delivery

- Word target: 2400-3200
- Source references:
 - ``reusable/implementation-plan.md``
 - ``templates/technical-proposal-part2.md``
 - ``content/06-implementation/main.md``
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Phase names and sequence identical across all proposal variants. Gate criteria stated for every phase.

13.1 Project Implementation & Delivery > Delivery Overview

> **MANDATORY DIAGRAM:** Implementation Timeline (Gantt-style: 6 phases with milestones). Include as ````mermaid` code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `implementation-timeline.mmd` for phase overview
- Word target: 200-300
- State phased methodology and governance logic

13.2 Project Implementation & Delivery > Phase Plan

- Word target: 1100-1400 total
- Include one subsection per phase:
 - Discovery and Requirements
 - Foundation and Setup
 - Configuration and Compliance
 - Integration and Testing
 - Go-Live
 - Hypercare
- For each phase include:
 - objective
 - key activities
 - outputs
 - dependencies
 - acceptance gate

13.3 Project Implementation & Delivery > Governance and Decision Structure

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: RACI matrix
- Word target: 250-350
- Include RACI / governance diagram guidance

13.4 Project Implementation & Delivery > Resource Model

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Resource allocation by phase (SettleMint/client roles)
- Word target: 250-350
- Table for SettleMint and client roles by phase

13.5 Project Implementation & Delivery > Risks to Delivery and Mitigations

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Delivery risk register (risk, likelihood, impact, mitigation, owner)
- Word target: 300-450
- Reference risk table but keep delivery-specific risks here

13.6 Project Implementation & Delivery > Visuals

- Visual 1: implementation timeline / gantt
- Visual 2: phase-gate model
- Visual 3: resource / governance matrix

13.7 Project Implementation & Delivery > Avoid

- avoid unrealistic timelines
- avoid phase descriptions without gate criteria

> **Section complete when:** Phase table with gate criteria present. RACI or role matrix included. All six phases covered.

14. Deployment

- Word target: 1800-2400
- Source references:
 - `reusable/deployment-options.md`
 - `templates/technical-proposal-part2.md`
 - `content/04-deployment/main.md`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Deployment model comparison uses identical criteria columns across all variants.

14.1 Deployment > Deployment Principles

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Deployment principle summary
- Word target: 150-250
- Focus:
 - portability
 - same platform capabilities across models
 - security and residency alignment

14.2 Deployment > Recommended Deployment Model

> **MANDATORY DIAGRAM:** Deployment Architecture (Kubernetes/cloud topology). Include as ``mermaid code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Mermaid diagram: Use `deployment-topology-saas.mmd` or `deployment-topology-onprem.mmd`
 - Screenshot: Monitoring screenshots showing deployment health
 - Screenshot: Settings screenshots showing environment configuration
- Word target: 300-450
- Placeholder-driven:
 - `[VARIABLE: selected model]`
 - `[VARIABLE: reasons selected]`
 - `[VARIABLE: key assumptions]`

14.3 Deployment > Deployment Options Considered

- Word target: 350-500
- Comparison table:

- Managed SaaS
- Dedicated/Private Cloud
- On-Premises
- Hybrid

14.4 Deployment > Infrastructure Requirements

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Infrastructure component inventory
- Word target: 350-450
- Cover:
 - Kubernetes/OpenShift
 - PostgreSQL
 - Redis
 - object storage
 - ingress/network

14.5 Deployment > Availability, Resilience, and DR Approach

> **MANDATORY DIAGRAM:** Disaster Recovery Architecture (block diagram: zones, failover, backup/restore). Include as `mermaid` code block.

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: RTO/RPO targets and recovery approach
- Word target: 350-450
- Cover:
 - zone distribution
 - backups
 - failover
 - RTO/RPO placeholders if needed

14.6 Deployment > Data Residency and Sovereignty

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Residency requirements mapping
- Word target: 200-300
- Include placeholders for jurisdiction requirements

14.7 Deployment > Visuals

- Visual 1: deployment comparison table
- Visual 2: logical topology diagram
- Visual 3: HA/DR pattern graphic

14.8 Deployment > Avoid

- avoid overcommitting to a model not chosen by bid
- avoid infra detail deeper than evaluator needs

> **Section complete when:** Recommended model stated with rationale. Comparison table present. Infrastructure requirements listed.

15. Training and Knowledge Transfer

- Word target: 900-1300
- Source references:
 - `reusable/training.md`
 - `templates/technical-proposal-part2.md`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Training audience categories consistent across proposals. No certification promises unless offered.

15.1 Training and Knowledge Transfer > Training Strategy

- Word target: 150-220

15.2 Training and Knowledge Transfer > Administrator Track

- Word target: 180-240

15.3 Training and Knowledge Transfer > Developer / Integration Track

- Word target: 180-240

15.4 Training and Knowledge Transfer > End-User / Operations Track

- Word target: 180-240

15.5 Training and Knowledge Transfer > Knowledge Transfer Method

- Word target: 180-260
- Include:
 - shadowing
 - guided labs
 - runbooks
 - operational readiness assessment

15.6 Training and Knowledge Transfer > Visuals

- one training-track table
- optional week-by-week handover timeline

15.7 Training and Knowledge Transfer > Avoid

- avoid generic LMS language
- avoid promising formal certification unless offered

> **Section complete when:** Training track table present. All audience types covered. Knowledge transfer method described.

16. Support & SLA

- Word target: 1400-1900
- Source references:
 - `reusable/support-sla.md`

- `templates/technical-proposal-part2.md`
- `content/07-support-sla/main.md`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: SLA figures match approved source exactly. Tier names and coverage hours never modified without approval.

16.1 Support & SLA > Support Model Overview

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Screenshot: Monitoring screenshots showing support dashboard
- Word target: 150-220

16.2 Support & SLA > Support Tiers

- Word target: 350-500
- Use tier comparison table

16.3 Support & SLA > Severity and Response Matrix

- Word target: 250-350
- Use severity table + response/resolution table

16.4 Support & SLA > Escalation and Incident Management

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Escalation path with levels, contacts, and thresholds
- Word target: 250-350
- Include escalation path visual or table

16.5 Support & SLA > Maintenance and Update Policy

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Maintenance window schedule and update cadence
- Word target: 250-350

16.6 Support & SLA > Service Reporting

- Word target: 120-180
- Cover uptime reports / review cadence / postmortem practice

16.7 Support & SLA > Avoid

- avoid changing SLA numbers without approval
- avoid custom support commitments unless bid-approved

> **Section complete when:** Support tier comparison table present. Severity/response matrix included. Escalation path defined.

17. Risk Management

- Word target: 800-1200
- Source references:

- `reusable/implementation-plan.md`
- bid-specific risks `[VARIABLE: source]`
- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Risk register uses identical column structure. Every risk has an owner and mitigation.

17.1 Risk Management > Risk Management Approach

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: Risk management framework summary
- Word target: 150-220

17.2 Risk Management > Risk Register

- Word target: 450-700
- Table columns:
 - ID
 - risk
 - likelihood
 - impact
 - mitigation
 - owner
 - status / trigger
- Minimum categories:
 - regulatory change
 - integration complexity
 - client dependency delay
 - security review timeline
 - third-party provider dependency
 - deployment/environment readiness

17.3 Risk Management > Governance of Risks

- Word target: 120-180

17.4 Risk Management > Avoid

- avoid generic enterprise risk waffle
- avoid separating risks from concrete mitigations

> **Section complete when:** Risk register table present with all required columns. Minimum risk categories covered. Every risk has owner and mitigation.

18. Compliance Matrix

- Word target: 1200-1800
- Source references:
 - bid requirements
 - all relevant master/reusable/content sources

- Required subsections:

Consistency anchor: Status codes consistent with legend. Every row traces to a specific RFP requirement ID.

18.1 Compliance Matrix > Usage Instructions

- Word target: 80-120
- Explain status coding only

18.2 Compliance Matrix > Status Legend

- Word target: 0-50
- Suggested codes:
 - Full
 - Partial
 - Configurable
 - Assumption
 - Out of Scope

18.3 Compliance Matrix > Detailed Matrix

- Word target: 900-1400
- Table columns:
 - requirement ID
 - requirement summary
 - response status
 - DALP / SettleMint response
 - source references
 - assumptions / notes
- Writer instructions:
 - keep concise and traceable
 - no sales prose
 - cross-check with main body wording

18.4 Compliance Matrix > Example Completed Row

- Word target: 100-150
- Include one generic example using placeholders only

18.5 Compliance Matrix > Avoid

- avoid contradictory status labels
- avoid long paragraph answers inside cells

> **Section complete when:** Status legend defined. Matrix table covers all RFP requirements. No contradictory status labels.

19. Support Appendix

Consistency anchor: Only included when bid requires it. Source-backed and compact.

19.1 Support Appendix (400-700 words, appendix-style)

- Write about: support tiers, SLA commitments, severity definitions, escalation paths, maintenance/update policy, reporting cadence, and service-credit rules where approved.
- Include: 1 support-tier comparison table and 1 severity/response/resolution table.
- Cover explicitly: named channels, coverage hours, incident escalation path, maintenance windows, and any service credit mechanics approved for proposal use.
- Tone: operational, precise, contract-aware.
- Reference: ``bid-manager/content/07-support-sla/main.md``, ``bid-manager/templates/sla-framework.md``.
- Do not: change SLA values, uptime targets, or service-credit terms without approval.

> **Section complete when:** Support tier comparison table present. Severity/response matrix included. Escalation path defined.

20. Writer's Checklist

- Word target: 600-900
- Structure as checklist only

Consistency anchor: All checklist items verified before submission. No items skipped.

20.1 Writer's Checklist > Structural Checks

- front matter correct
- no manual numbering in headings
- section order matches chosen variant
- word targets approximately met
- visuals specified for major sections

20.2 Writer's Checklist > Evidence Checks

- every factual claim source-backed
- references aligned to actual source files
- no invented metrics/outcomes
- named examples only from approved reference file

20.3 Writer's Checklist > Customization Checks

- all placeholders resolved where required
- client name, programme name, and scope consistent
- selected references match bid context
- deployment model consistent across document

20.4 Writer's Checklist > Tone Checks

- no hype language
- no consultant-speak
- no roadmap-as-reality
- no duplicate DALP definitions

20.5 Writer's Checklist > Production Checks

- tables render cleanly in Word
- diagrams labeled and editable where possible
- TOC auto-build works
- appendix / compliance references consistent

> **Section complete when:** All structural, evidence, customization, tone, and production checks listed.

21. Appendix Guidance

- Include only if bid requires:
 - glossary
 - certification summary
 - API reference summary
 - additional matrices
- Use source-backed, compact appendices only
- Do not hide missing core content in appendices

Consistency anchor: Only included when bid requires it. Source-backed and compact.